# FX Technical Update

## A hawkish FOMC propels the dollar trend to a new high; we still see the prospects of more backing and filling into the early weeks of 2025

**Technical Strategy**

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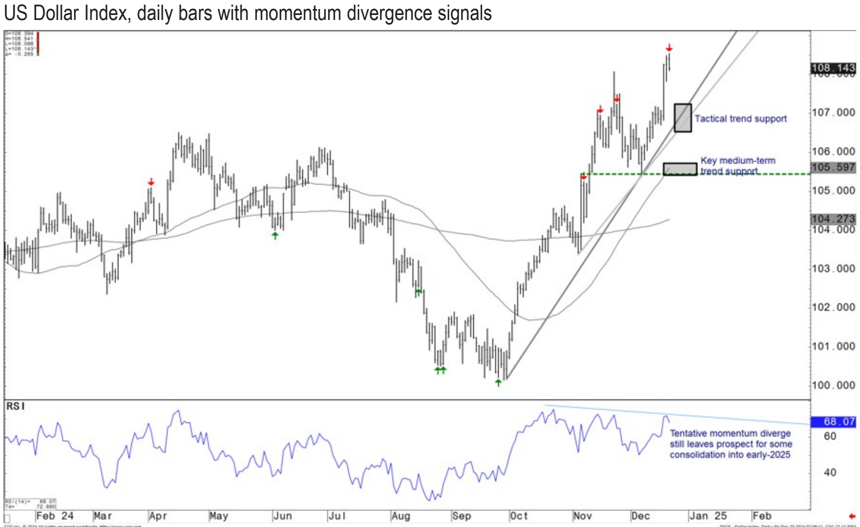
- EUR/USD tries to bounce from the Nov low after the surprisingly hawkish FOMC communication. While the medium-term bear trend stays firmly intact, we still see the prospects for backing and filling into the early weeks of 2025. Key short-term resistance rests at 1.0453-1.047.
- Cable tries to rebound after undercutting the Nov low following this week's FOMC meeting. Look for 1.2604-1.27 resistance to cap short-term rebounds. Medium-term bears keep the agenda while below resistance surrounding 1.28.
- The USD/JPY rally tentatively fades from the 156.75-157.23 resistance zone again, but there is little to suggest that reversal will stick at this point. We think any further attempt to rally toward the 161.973 will fade. For now, the medium-term bull trend stays intact while above the 151.073-153.16 support zone.
- AUD/USD tried to find its footing near the 0.6349 Aug panic low only to reaccelerate to next support at 0.617-0.6185 after the surprisingly hawkish FOMC meeting. While we suspect the pair can base here and rebound, we would not suggest fading the weakness until the early signs of a bullish reversal pattern set up. Look for the 0.6349-0.6396 area to now act as a key resistance zone.



**Figure 1: The US Dollar Index extends to a new trend high after the hawkish FOMC communication but triggers a tentative momentum divergence signal as that move fades into the week's end. Albeit from a new trend high, we still see the prospects for further consolidation into the early weeks of next year.**

US Dollar Index, daily bars with momentum divergence signals




Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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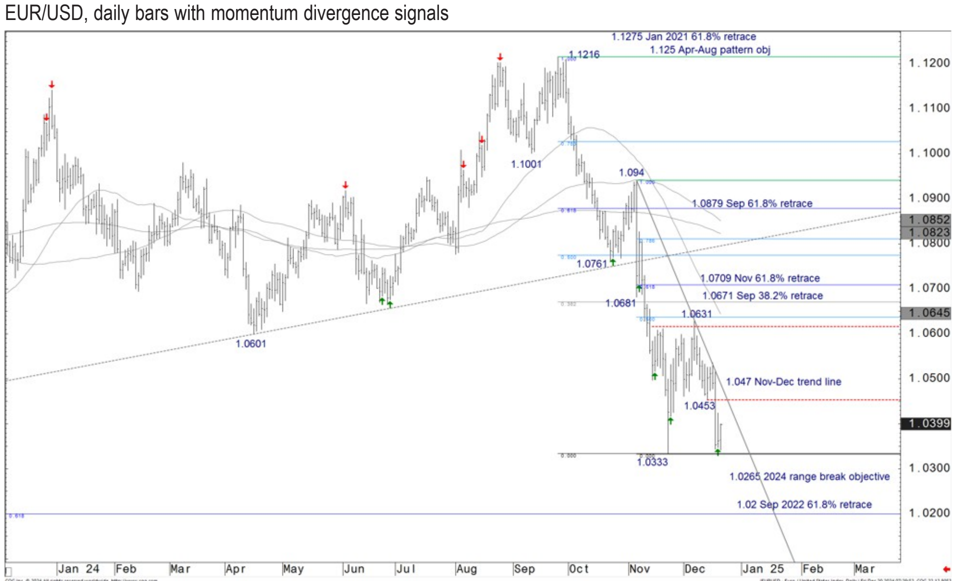
# EUR/USD bounces from Nov low but needs to overcome levels near 1.045 to derail the near-term bear trend

A surprisingly hawkish Dec FOMC meeting accelerated the short-term Treasury backup and broad dollar trend with it, taking EUR/USD back to the 1.0333 Nov trough (Figure 2). The pair staged a tentative rebound from that developing support layer and triggered a momentum divergence buy signal on the daily time frame as it did so. Those mean reversion trade signals naturally have a higher fail rate in a dynamic trending environment, which the market has been in in the weeks surrounding the US election. As a result, we are hesitant to put too much stock in the current signal, but suspect the pair can see further backing and filling within the Nov-Dec range heading into the early weeks of next year. Within that range, key short-term trend resistance rests at the 1.0453 post-FOMC pattern break and 1.047 Nov-Dec trend line. A move through that area would open the door for a broader retracement and potential test of range resistance in the 1.06-handles. That zone is critical for the health of the medium-term bearish trend dynamics, in our view. On the downside, next support rests at the 1.0265 2024 range measured move objective and 1.02 Sep 2022 61.8% retrace. We think the pair can build a more lasting bottom near that support early next year, but would not suggest fading initial weakness into the area. We would first want to see tactical signs of base building near that support.

**Figure 2: EUR/USD tries to bounce from the Nov low after the surprisingly hawkish FOMC communication. While the medium-term bear trend stays firmly intact, we still see the prospects for backing and filling into the early weeks of 2025. Key short-term resistance rests at 1.0453-1.047. Medium-term bears stay in control while below 1.06-handle resistance. The next support levels sit in 1.02-handles.**

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals

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# GBP/USD pressures the November low with key short-term trend resistance at 1.26-1.27

**Cable** tries to stabilize near the Nov low after the FOMC meeting and resulting Treasury-led impulse to higher DM bond yields. The tentative bullish momentum divergence signal that triggered into the week's end points to an increased probability for mean reversion with the medium-term downtrend. Look for a short-term rebound to find initial selling pressure near the 1.2604 Nov-Dec pattern low and 1.27 Sep-Nov channel trend line. In our view, medium-term bears keep firm control of the market provided the pair continues to trade below key levels surrounding 1.28. That includes a cluster of moving averages, the post-election bear trend acceleration point, and Dec rebound high (Figure 3). On the downside, the next support levels rest at the 1.2385 Dec pattern objective, 1.2335 Jul 2023-Sep 2024 equal swings objective, 1.2299 Apr low, 1.2224 Sep-Dec .618 swing objective, and 1.2219 Sep-Nov channel trend line. We suspect the pair can build a more lasting trough near that support in the early months of 2025.

**Figure 3: Cable tries to rebound after undercutting the Nov low following this week's FOMC meeting. Look for 1.2604-1.27 resistance to cap short-term rebounds. Medium-term bears keep the agenda while below resistance surrounding 1.28.**

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals


Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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# The hawkish FOMC saw USD/JPY retest 157.23 Fibonacci resistance

**USD/JPY** retested the 156.75 Nov high and 157.23 Jul 78.6% retrace resistance cluster after the hawkish FOMC meeting (Figure 4). We had thought bought the tactical DM yield trends and correlated USD/JPY move looked mature by the end of last week. The surprising shift in Fed communication ran over that view. That said, the relative pricing of the implied terminal easing rate had converged on the market-implied neutral rate (5y5y OIS rate) after the meeting, which in turn leaves little room for the front end to cheapen further unless the market is willing to contemplate a pivot to potential hikes. There is risk that the longer end of the market continues to trend cheaper, but with 10-year JGBs bearishly pressuring its own 1.10-1.14% key support layer, we see equal prospects that the US and Japanese markets can lead such a move. As such, we think the USD/JPY rally is likely to fade upon any further attempt to extend toward the 161.93 summer peak. Resistance between current levels and that peak include the 159.256 Sep-Dec .618 swing objective and 160.60 Sep-Nov channel. That summer high faded below longer-term resistance at 163.69-165.815. On the downside, look for short-term mean reversion to find support at 151.073-153.16 support, which includes a cluster of moving averages, the Sep channel, and recent price pivots. Medium-term support now rests at the 148.645 Dec low and 146.495-147.172 Oct base breakout zone.

**Figure 4: The USD/JPY rally tentatively fades from the 156.75-157.23 resistance zone again but there is little to suggest that reversal will stick at this point. We think any further attempt to rally toward the 161.973 will fade. For now, the medium-term bull trend stays intact while above the 151.073-153.16 support zone.**

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals


Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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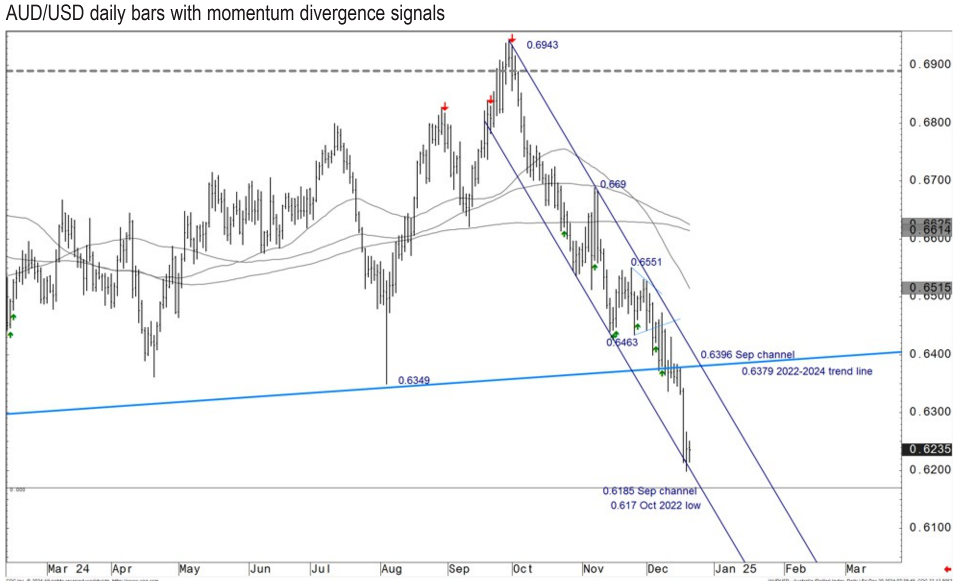
# AUD/USD slide re-accelerates into the Oct 2022 low

**AUD/USD** tried to decelerate near support clustered in the 0.63-handles, but that move re-accelerated after the surprisingly hawkish FOMC meeting into next support at the 0.6185 Sep channel and 0.617 Oct 2022 trough (Figure 5). The pair is deeply oversold, and after the persistent slide from the 0.6943 and multi-year range resistance, sentiment is likely pressed into extreme territory. However, we need to see clear signs of the early phase of a bullish reversal pattern before we would suggest fading the trend. For that, we will look first for renewed signs of trend deceleration near current levels. That more two-sided price action would then transition into the early portion of a base pattern. Until then, we suspect any near-term bullish mean reversion is likely to fade near the 0.6336 Dec 11 low, 0.6349 Aug panic low, 0.6379 2022-2024 trend line, and 0.6396 Sep channel. On the downside, a break through the Oct 2022 low would turn our attention to the 0.6042 Mar 2020 78.6% retrace and 0.6022 Feb 2021-Sep 2024 .618 swing objective.

**Figure 5: AUD/USD tried to find its footing near the 0.6349 Aug panic low only to reaccelerate to next support at 0.617-0.6185 after the surprisingly hawkish FOMC meeting. While we suspect the pair can base here and rebound, we would not suggest fading the weakness until the early signs of a bullish reversal pattern set up. Look for the 0.6349-0.6396 area to now act as a key resistance zone.**

AUD/USD daily bars with momentum divergence signals

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